

Figure 12: My Definitions seems to be global-scope

Editor is probably obvious, but still: if you have a block on the canvas that you don't need/want, simply drag the block over the bin, and release, to delete it.

Now, to sum up what we've covered this far: we designed the application's layout (and non-visible components) in the AIA Web application, and defined its behaviour in the Blocks Editor. Next, we move on to the third step in the chain: connecting the Blocks Editor to an Android phone, or to an emulator running on the same PC.

Emulator included

I've dealt with connecting a phone running Android 1.5 to the PC, and to the Blocks Editor, in the box '*Platform and set-up with FreeRunner*'. However, it can sometimes be irritating to keep plugging in your phone, and tying it up with App Inventor, especially if it's your main phone. You don't need to do this. The App Inventor Extras package that you need to download and install on your PC (see the set-up box) includes an emulator for an Android 2.1 phone, so you don't need a real phone connected to the USB port. The Android emulator mimics the hardware and software features of a mobile device, with some obvious exceptions: it cannot receive or place actual phone calls; you can't 'shake' it, obviously, since there is no real accelerometer; and without an actual GPS chip, you can't get real GPS readings. But for all these, it does provide a pretty good simulation of an Android phone.

There are a variety of navigation and control keys, which you can 'press' using your mouse or keyboard, to control Android and any applications. An application you are developing in App Inventor, and which is running on the emulator, can use platform services to invoke other applications, access the network, play audio and video, store and retrieve data, put up user notifications, and more.

To let you model and test your application against multiple phones/versions of Android, the emulator supports Android Virtual Device (AVD) configurations, in which you can specify the Android platform version that you want to run

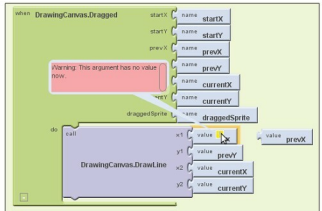


Figure 13: Warning: "This argument has no value now"

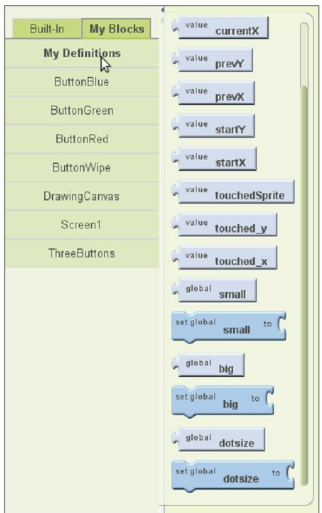


Figure 14: List of definitions now inverted

in the emulator, as well as the hardware options and emulator skin files that you want to use.

To use the emulator, find the directory where App Inventor Extras were installed, and in it the *commands-for-appinventor* folder; there, run the command named *run-emulator*. If you